

Jun 27, 2026

Strvx Robotics Briefing — Kenneth Hinkle

Invited Kenneth Hinkle

Attachments 📎 Strvx Robotics Briefing — Kenneth Hinkle

Meeting records 📋 Transcript

Summary

Discussion focused on integrating autonomous drone software for improved airfield monitoring and maintenance efficiency via system automation.

Manual Inspection Operational Bottlenecks

Manual airfield inspections create significant operational bottlenecks and labor inefficiencies. Autonomous drone integration offers potential for continuous monitoring to augment existing inspection processes.

System Integration Budget Requirements

Automated triggers for work orders were established as a primary requirement for efficient maintenance. Pricing models will prioritize scalability to prevent cost overruns experienced with previous vendors.

Regulatory Compliance Operational Standards

Federal Aviation Administration regulations necessitate a human-in-the-loop for reviewing critical alerts during autonomous operations. Drone capabilities also allow for potential security expansions like license plate reading.

Decisions

Aligned

- **Work order system integration plan** The drone solution will interface directly with the airport's existing work order system to automate reporting and maintenance workflows.
- **Two-phase demo execution strategy** The demonstration project is structured into two phases: one for general airfield monitoring and a second for specific security coverage during the Masters event.

We've **updated the Decisions section** using your feedback.

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Next steps

- ☐ [Strvx Robotics] Prepare Demo: Create a presentation for airfield monitoring and security for the Masters event.
- ☐ [Kenneth Hinkle] Share Mobile Number: Provide mobile contact information to Alex Battikha to facilitate communication.

Details

- **Strivex Robotics Introduction:** Alex Battikha and Nicholas introduced Strivex Robotics, a company based in San Francisco that develops a software intelligence layer for autonomous drones designed to monitor and secure valuable assets and critical infrastructure ([00:00:26](#)).
- **Current Airport Operational Procedures:** Kenneth Hinkle explained that the airport currently relies on manual inspections by operation agents to monitor

runways and perimeter fences. These agents perform mandatory checks daily, starting between 6:00 and 7:00 AM to inspect runways before commercial flights take off. Discrepancies are tracked using a program called Aeros Simple, which issues work orders to the maintenance team; agents are responsible for reinspecting the area after repairs are completed to ensure satisfaction ([00:01:26](#)).

- **Strategic Value of Drone Technology:** Kenneth Hinkle discussed the potential benefits of autonomous drone integration, acknowledging that while airports are typically no-drone zones, obtaining FAA permission could revolutionize airfield monitoring. During high-traffic events like the Masters, which involved 4,200 operations last April, a "bird's eye view" of the ramp and airfield would significantly improve efficiency by allowing staff to track aircraft parking and conditions without needing to physically travel to each location ([00:06:01](#)).
- **Operational Bottlenecks and Efficiency:** Kenneth Hinkle identified the primary operational bottleneck as the reliance on manual labor, which is costly and results in inefficient use of time due to downtime between inspections and the physical constraints of moving around the airfield during active traffic. Strivex Robotics discussed how drone technology could provide continuous, flexible monitoring, with the potential for long-term automation of deficiency reporting to augment or eventually phase out some manual agent tasks ([00:08:05](#)).
- **Integration with Work Order Systems:** The participants agreed on the necessity of a seamless interface between the drone monitoring system and the airport's existing work order system. Kenneth Hinkle emphasized that if a drone detects issues such as runway cracks or painting needs, the system should automatically trigger a work order, thereby streamlining the maintenance process ([00:09:22](#)).
- **Budgeting and Scalability Constraints:** Kenneth Hinkle expressed concerns regarding affordability, citing a previous experience with a vendor, Autonomo, where costs increased from an initial \$25,000 to \$100,000 for subsequent project phases. Strivex Robotics acknowledged these concerns and committed to working within the airport's budget to develop a scalable and affordable pricing model ([00:11:26](#)).
- **Demo Planning and Regulatory Requirements:** Strivex Robotics proposed conducting two separate demonstrations: one focusing on general airfield

monitoring and another tailored to security needs for the Masters event, including threat detection. Regarding regulatory compliance, Strivex Robotics clarified that while the drones operate autonomously, Federal Aviation Administration regulations require a human-in-the-loop for reviews of critical alerts, such as the detection of a potential security threat ([00:12:22](#)).

- **Expanded Potential Use Cases:** Kenneth Hinkle suggested additional applications for the drone technology, such as integrating license plate readers for parking lot security. This capability could potentially reduce the reliance on fixed camera infrastructure and enable the drones to assist law enforcement, such as the marshals or police department, in identifying security risks ([00:14:09](#)).
- **Closing and Contact Information:** The meeting concluded with Alex Battikha and Kenneth Hinkle agreeing to maintain communication regarding the upcoming demo. Kenneth Hinkle provided mobile contact details to ensure direct coordination as the project progresses ([00:15:02](#)).

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